

THIS IS TECHNOLOGY, CULTURE AND SCIENCE WITH A DIFFERENCE, AND THAT DIFFERENCE IS USUALLY ENOUGH TO MAKE MOST NORMAL PEOPLE GO "WTF?"

## This month in ALT:

This month in ALT, we will list out some watches worn in space, we will look into some electric vehicles with the most ridiculous ranges, we explore the concept of robo-lawyers, and more.



## NFTs on your Smart TV

Samsung recently announced a new "NFT Aggregation Platform" for its smart TVs. The platform, which will be accessible on Samsung's MicroLed, Neo QLED, and The Frame models, allows customers to browse and purchase NFTs right from their televisions. Users can examine art and see other essential details, such as who made the work, as well as relevant blockchain metadata, by using the platform. <https://digit.in/nftsonstv>

## WHAT'S NEW

# Data retention to be abolished in Germany

**T**he keeping of telecommunications data for no cause, according to the German Minister of Justice, could be phased away soon. Finally, the new German administration intends to alter the German data retention law to conform to European and German constitutional privacy rights. Any unauthorised storage of telecommunications data will be forbidden.

Provisions for data retention for several weeks are currently incorporated in the recently modified German Telecommunications Act, although they have been temporarily suspended due to admin-



istrative court decisions. The European Court of Justice (ECJ) has frequently stated that recording

all telephone and Internet data without distinction is incompatible with the EU's fundamental privacy rights. As a result, Buschmann supports the quick-freeze approach, which would require providers to virtually freeze connection and location data at the request of law authorities.

<https://digit.in/datagermany>

## Stoppage of new game licences in China continues

**C**hina is still delaying the issuance of new game licences to app developers working on the App Store and other platforms, citing regulatory slowness as a reason for the closure of 140,000 small game studios and related businesses in the country. To sell games on the App Store and other app marketplaces, game makers must be licensed under Chinese law. Despite the fact that regulators ceased awarding



new licences in late 2021, it appears that the restriction will be extended beyond 2022.

According to sources, regulators chose to freeze game licence approvals in July because licences for new games were deemed "a little too aggressive"

in the first half of 2021. It wasn't clear how long the sabbatical would last, however one insider suggested it would be "a while." A game can't be posted to the regional App Store or updated if it doesn't have a licence. To comply with local legislation, Apple has started withholding updates and removing games from the China App Store that do not have a licence from the NPPA since July 2020.

<https://digit.in/nonewgames>



## Better websites have better passwords

Passwords like "123456," "qwerty," and even "password" are the most popular year after year. It is not difficult to discover websites that will take even the most heinous passwords without complaint and that's the primary issue. <https://digit.in/badpassword>



## Can you delete your social media?

It's one thing to want to deactivate your account; it's quite another to actually be able to do so. The largest networks have made it extremely difficult to deactivate your account. Here's a story that explains how to delete various social media accounts. <https://digit.in/byesocialmedia>



## Goodbye, BlackBerry

BlackBerry phones, considered the pinnacle of mobile technology, are being phased out. On January 4, the firm stated that services for outdated devices would be discontinued. They will "no longer reliably work" at that time, according to BlackBerry. <https://digit.in/blackberryout>